

VERSION 1.0 - PRODUCTION CANDIDATE

Urdu Workbook

اردو

Writing foundations, core grammar, 1,000 audited vocabulary entries, and 1,000 human-contributed bilingual practice sentences with handwriting and retrieval space.

Foundations

Natural, idiomatic learner language takes priority over artificial uniqueness. Genuine homographs are retained when their learner meaning and grammatical role differ. Transliteration is intentionally omitted from sentence drills rather than teaching inconsistent ad-hoc romanization.

Foundations

Target register: standard Urdu in Nastaliq. These pages orient deliberate practice; the vocabulary and sentence sections provide the bulk of retrieval work.

Script / alphabet reference

ا ب پ ت ٹ ث ج چ ح خ د ڈ ذ ر ز س ش ص ض ط ظ ع غ ف ق ک گ
ل م ن ں و ہ ع ی ے

Use this as a compact reference, then practice connected words rather than isolated shapes alone.

Numbers 0-10

۱۰ ۹ ۸ ۷ ۶ ۵ ۴ ۳ ۲ ۱ ۰
صفر ۰ ایک ۱ دو ۲ تین ۳ چار ۴ پانچ ۵ چھ ۶ سات ۷ آٹھ ۸ نو ۹ دس ۱۰

Writing system

Urdu is written from right to left in a Perso-Arabic script, commonly in Nastaliq. Connected words, vertical stacking, and baseline flow matter more than copying isolated glyphs indefinitely.

Sounds and spelling

Urdu adds letters and conventions for sounds not represented the same way in Arabic or Persian, including retroflex and aspirated consonants. Short vowels are often unmarked.

Word order

Neutral Urdu word order is usually subject-object-verb. Postpositions follow noun phrases, so whole chunks are safer than word-for-word English mapping.

Gender and agreement

Nouns have grammatical gender. Adjectives and verbs can change for gender and number, and agreement also interacts with tense/aspect and postpositions.

Respect and pronouns

آپ is the normal respectful/formal second-person form and takes plural-style agreement. تم is familiar; تو is highly intimate or potentially rude outside close contexts.

Ergativity

In many perfective transitive clauses, نے marks the agent and verb agreement may follow the object instead. Treat this as a recurring pattern rather than forcing English subject agreement onto Urdu.

Handwriting warm-up

Copy five useful words from today's lesson, then write them again from memory.

Sources, licensing, and QA scope

Vocabulary: drawn from this repository's canonical audited top-1,000 deck for the language. Repository source and audit records remain the source of truth.

Sentences: selected from the ManyThings bilingual exports of the Tatoeba Project. Each redistributed pair retains the supplied sentence-level attribution. Tatoeba textual data is distributed under CC BY 2.0 France.

Quality scope: release gates check canonical dataset integrity, row counts, duplicate handling, script plausibility, source attribution, PDF structure, font embedding, and renderability. These checks materially reduce risk but do not substitute for independent native-speaker editorial certification; no absolute error-free claim is made.